

Week 3 teaching guide

Build the world · GROW computing · 40 minutes

I can create a maze, a player and a finish as three sprites.

Before the lesson

Start a new project with W03_Blank.sb3. Open the separate teacher model and check your school save route. Choose pupil booklets by current need. Keep the HTML or slides and the reference page ready.

Teacher example: W03_Teacher_Model.sb3. Pupil access file: W03_Blank.sb3. The starter is blank.

Stage and time	Teach and check
Arrival 0-3	Open W03_Blank.sb3. Today you will create three sprites.
Starter 3-6	Look at the small player and the large player. Point to what you would change.
I Do 6-11	Maze holds the walls. Finish marks the goal.
We Do 11-18	Trace a route together. Choose one repair and test it.
I Do 2 18-21	Place Player away from a wall. Look at the start x and y.
We Do 2 · Task 21-25	Name each of the three sprites. Agree one useful layout change.
Independent Task 25-35	Create Maze, Player and Finish. Check that Player fits through your route.
Exit 35-40	Save as W03_Maze.sb3. Show what your design idea changed.

Independent Task: allow 25-32 for making and testing, then 32-35 for an individual demonstration and pupil voice. Exit stays at 35-40.

Choose the task route

Step by step: Create one sprite at a time using the role cards.

Main task: Create three sprites and check a clear route.

Challenge: Compare player sizes and repair a narrow gap.

Teaching notes and answers

Use the teacher model for demonstration, then return to pupil construction

Use the Week 2 mission choice. Pupils create all three sprites themselves. The blank starter supplies only a plain backdrop. A simple maze with one inner wall is enough for this first layout. Paint walls as a Maze sprite on a transparent costume; do not fill the whole costume with an opaque background. Name all three sprites exactly when using the later block references. Position a custom Maze before programming it, then leave it fixed. Show the x/y boxes so pupils can record their own safe start.

Block and design reference

Find this	Use it like this
Maze	Choose a Sprite > Paint. Name it Maze. Draw walls on its costume.
Player	Paint or choose a small sprite. Name it Player.
Finish	Paint or choose a visible sign. Name it Finish.
Position	Drag Player to its start. Note the x and y boxes below the stage.

Expected answers

1. The three roles are Maze, Player and Finish. A maze painted only as a backdrop does not meet this outcome.
2. A larger player needs more room. In the model the 16-unit player fits the 60-unit gap; the 80-unit player does not.
3. The model has a route from (-180,-120), up to y110, right to x0, down to y-110, right to x180, then up to y120. Pupils may design a much shorter route.
4. The project has no controls yet. Dragging or a paper token checks the layout; this is appropriate in Week 3.

A likely misconception

A picture on the backdrop is different from a Maze sprite. A pretty maze with no usable route needs a layout change.

Access and evidence

Record the pupil action and the support used

Flexible support

Current need	Adaptation
Reading or memory	Use short instructions, the reference and one visible next action. Read aloud privately.
Communication	Accept speech, pointing, drawing or exact-word scribing. Give thinking time.
Keyboard or pointer access	Use an agreed school access device or let the pupil direct an adult. Record the method and check evidence arrangements with the UAS lead.
Regulation or attention	Offer quiet work, a pause and the same return step. Do not make a public performance necessary.
Ready to transfer	Use Challenge after the common goal. Ask for a prediction and explanation rather than extra writing.

Pupil voice with a response

Which passage, object or mission detail should change? Choose one useful layout change.

Ask “What I said, and what it changed”. Listen and reply: use it now, adapt it together, or defer it with a reason. Make any agreed change visible. An adult may record exact pupil words. No signature is required from the pupil’s audience.

Individual evidence

AQA 71638 outcome 1: Observe each pupil creating and selecting all three sprites. Record what they did and the support used. A downloaded finished maze does not establish creation.

Pupil action or check	Date and support used
I created and named Maze, Player and Finish.	
My Maze is a sprite I can select.	
Player fits through the gaps.	
I saved and reopened my project.	

Record completed outcomes on the AQA summary sheet. Do not infer creation from supplied code. Outcomes 5 and 6 remain in Weeks 7 and 8; check every outcome individually.

If a device is unavailable

Use the role cards and a paper maze. Trace a route with a small token, then compare a larger one. Complete sprite creation and saving in Scratch at the next available device session.

[AQA 71638 Programming with Scratch unit 6](#)